

5 Easy Steps to Making Your Own Pickles

I'm a dill pickle addict. Once that seal has been popped on my jar of Claussen dills, I usually take care of that jar within 24 hours. Pickles aren't cheap, however, so I went for a DIY alternative that tastes pretty darn good (and you won't need any canning abilities to make these homemade pickles).

Pickle making isn't sexy, and it won't get you any special perks beyond the joys of eating your own pickles. But it's cheap, quick, and gives you a sense of accomplishment that you won't get from throwing an overpriced jar into your grocery cart. Here's a recipe that that will take care of your pickle cravings with little money and even less time:

1. Grab your cukes

Pickle connoisseurs will try to tell you that you can't use the overgrown ones to make pickles. You can; it just won't

be quite the same. If you don't mind eating pickled seeds (I happen to love them), there is no reason you can't use up some of those giant, longer-than-your-arm cucumbers in your pickling recipe. If you don't like the mushy insides, you can always cut the cukes in half lengthwise and scrape out the seedy pulp with a spoon. No hard feelings. (Note: Be sure to wash the cukes and scrub them well or rinse them in a veggie wash—you will be leaving the skins on for flavor and texture.)

2. Cut them

This isn't rocket science. You can slice them in any manner you choose. (I prefer short, stubby pickles for snacking, but you can slice them thin or in hamburger-sized slices, as well.) If the cucumbers are small enough, you can leave them whole (but pickling time will be longer).

3. Prepare your brine

Simply boil 3 cups water (bottled is preferred), 1/8 cup kosher or sea salt (not iodized), and 1 tablespoon white vinegar. Once it has come to a full boil, remove from heat and allow it to cool to room temperature (you don't want to boil your cucumbers).